I had the phone on speaker. I was on the second floor of Clarence House, standing by the window, surrounded by beautiful furnishings. Lovely room. The lamps were low, the rug at my feet was a work of art. I pressed my face against the window's cold polished glass and asked Flea to see me one last time, at least talk it over.

Soldiers went marching past the house. Changing of the guard.

No.

She was firm.

Weeks later I got a call from one of the friends who'd set us up at the bar. *Didja hear? Flea's got back with the old boyfriend!*

Has she?

Wasn't meant to be, I guess.

Right.

The friend told me he'd heard that it was Flea's mother who told her to end things, who warned her that the press would destroy her life. *They'll hound you to the gates of Hell*, her mother said.

Yeah, I told the friend. *Mums do know best.*

45.

I STOPPED SLEEPING.

I simply stopped. I was so disappointed, so profoundly dejected, that I just stayed up night after night, pacing, thinking. Wishing I had a TV.

But I was living on a military base now, in a cell-like room.

Then, mornings, on zero sleep, I'd try to fly an Apache.

Recipe for disaster.

I tried herbal remedies. They helped, a bit, I was able to get an hour or two of sleep, but they left me feeling brain-dead most mornings.

Then the Army informed me I'd be hitting the road—a series of maneuvers and exercises.